



Strategy Trade

Global Markets Research

14 May 2026

Rates - Asia ex-Japan

Hong Kong rates: Maintain pay 10y position

A pick up in bond supply, recovery in residential property prices and cheap valuation are key drivers.

Trade: Maintain pay Jun-10y HK IRS (vs. 2/3 US) with a conviction level of 4/5, targeting 40bp in gains from entry.

Rationale

1. **A pick up in non-financial HKD bond supply.** Since the start of 2024, long-end HK rates (as a spread vs US) have been moving lower, with the exception of Q3 2025, when the aggregate balance dropped after USD/HKD reached 7.85. One key driver of long-end HK rates' outperformance was the lack of long duration in HKD bond supply and subdued loan growth, which likely led to many bank treasury desks having to receive long-tenor IRS to obtain duration exposure. However, the supply-demand imbalance may have finally improved. A number of local ex-financial entities (the HK Airport Authority, MTR, West Kowloon Cultural District Authorities and the Hong Kong government) have issued HKD bonds of 10y or longer since April. We believe this should set the tone for more regular issuance going forward for projects such as Northern Metropolis, which the Hong Kong government expects to complete in the mid-2030s.
2. **Hong Kong's macro stabilization and residential property recovery.** The other factor that has kept long-end HK rates low has been subdued loan growth, which has driven the loan-to-deposit (LTD) ratio lower. This has not yet improved, with the latest March LTD ratio (72.3%) still close to lows. That said, we remain optimistic that the recent macro rebound (Q1 GDP growth data came in well above expectations at 5.9% y-o-y) and the strong recovery in residential property prices (back to their highest level since October 2023) could still gradually spill over to higher mortgage loans and overall loan growth.
3. **Long-end HK-US spread remains wide.** The current spread between 10y HK and US IRS, at -73bp, remains well below its historical average, even though it has already rebounded slightly from the low of -88bp in March. We believe the 10y HK-US spread can easily narrow to -50bp or narrower if loan growth rebounds, while it may still not drop much from here (maybe oscillate around -80bp) if the LTD ratio stays around current levels. On the front-end, Hong Kong rates have been bid up as well, as reflected in the higher 3m HIBOR fixing since the start of April, thanks to a hot IPO pipeline, some outright USD/HKD buying and ahead of dividend payments by Chinese companies to H-share investors. However, we generally believe those factors are better understood and priced and the real opportunity exists in the long-end instead.

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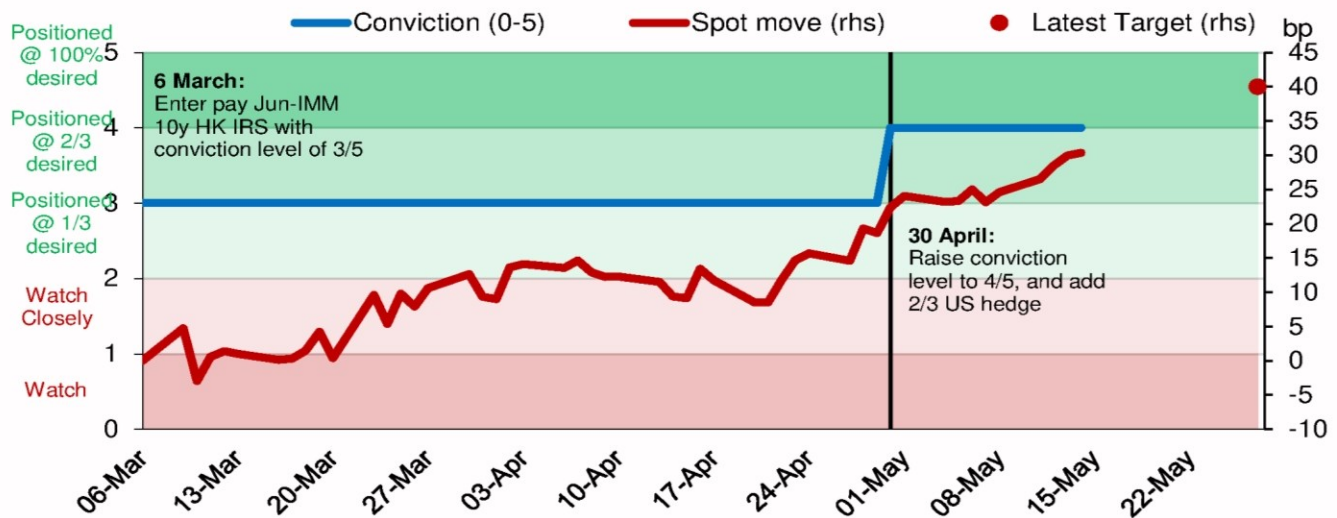
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Fig. 1: Pay Jun-10y HK IRS (2/3 versus US, conviction 4/5, target 40bp gains by end-May)



Source: Nomura Note: Conviction scale: 1 - Watch ; 2 - Watch Closely ; 3 - Positioned @ 1/3 desired ; 4 - Positioned @ 2/3 desired ; 5 - Positioned @ 100% desired

Fig. 2: Trade Ideas

Trade	Target	Timeline	Conviction (0-5)	Entry Date
Short USD/CNH	6.6	end-Aug	3	8-May-26
Long 12m USD/HKD	7.8	12-May-27	3	8-May-26
Receive Australia 3m1y	30bp gain	end-Jun	3	30-Apr-26
Short AUD/NZD	1.1800	end-Jun	3	30-Apr-26
Long CNH vs 6FX abridged basket	-	-	2	30-Apr-26
Long CHF/JPY	206.5	end-Jun	4	30-Apr-26
Pay Jun-IMM 5y Taiwan NDIRS	2.40%	end-May	3	24-Apr-26
Long EUR/PHP	73.5	end-Jul	4	17-Apr-26
Long EUR/SEK	11.2	end-Jun	3	17-Apr-26
Receive Dec-1y Korea NDIRS	3.60%	mid-Jun	3	13-May-26
Long 30y CGB vs. pay Jun-3y China NDIRS (extra pay in 3y)	15bp gain	end-May	3	14-Apr-26
Receive Jun-IMM 5y THOR (75% vs. US)	20bp gain	end-May	3	8-Apr-26
Long EUR/INR	113	end-Aug	4	1-Apr-26
Pay Jun-IMM 10y HK IRS (2/3 vs. US)	40bp gain	end-May	4	6-Mar-26
Long USD/THB	-	-	1	2-Feb-26
Long 9m USD/HKD	7.8	27-Oct-26	3	23-Jan-26
Long 12m USD/HKD	7.8	27-Jan-27	3	23-Jan-26
Long SGD/IDR	14,200	end-Aug	5	9-Jan-26
Long EUR/GBP	0.8950	end-Jun	4	9-Jan-26

Source: Nomura

Please see [Strategy portfolio update](#) (7 May 2026) for our full portfolio.

Appendix A-1

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